

Accounting

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TEACHING ASSISTANTS:
TBD. Will be posted on Canvas the first week of class.

**This syllabus is subject to change*

DESCRIPTION

In this course, we will examine fundamental accounting concepts and principles. The course is intended to provide you with the basic skills necessary to understand and analyze financial statements as well as to prepare you for more advanced financial statement analysis courses. The objective is not to train you as an accountant but rather to help you become an informed user of financial statements. Classes will include interactive lectures and discussions about financial accounting principles and practices. Short cases involving corporate financial statements will also be used to illustrate accounting concepts and to explore the disclosure strategies of companies.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

At the close of this course you will be able to:

- Read and understand financial statements
- Find and analyze information provided in real world financial statements (as opposed to only text book examples)
- Ask management the right questions about their financial statements
- Understand basic international differences in financial statements

COURSE MATERIALS

Hardcopy & electronic: The hardcopy textbook package includes: both the hard and electronic versions (eBook) of 12th Edition of Financial Accounting by Libby, Libby, Hodge (published by McGraw-Hill) and Access to the McGraw-Hill Connect Assignment System ("Connect"). Please note that you need the access code to Connect.

Regardless of how you access the textbook, it is REQUIRED that you register on the Connect website.

COURSE SCHEDULE

See course schedule document.

ASSIGNMENTS & DELIVERABLES

Reading Assignments

See course schedule document.

Graded Homework (McGraw-Hill Connect): Several homework problems are assigned for each chapter. Complete the assigned problems on the Connect website. You can check your work on Connect before you submit it (Connect will tell you whether your answers are correct or incorrect as you work through each problem). You have three opportunities to submit the correct response before incorrect responses are counted against you. Connect provides an assignment score and a comprehensive correct solution. The graded assignments will count 15% toward your final score. Assignments submitted late will not be considered.

Homework is due by the date of the final. You may skip one of the graded homework assignments (I will leave out the assignment with the lowest (or no) grade.)

Collaboration: Collaboration with classmates on homework is allowed and encouraged. However, submitted solutions should be your own work. If you are working on homework with several of your classmates, you will notice that correct answers for your assignment will often differ from correct answers of your classmates' assignments.

Exams

The **quizzes** will consist of short quizzes every in-class session (approximately 30 minutes each). The content of the quizzes will depend on class progress.

The **final project** will be comprehensive of all course topics and materials. The goal will be to transfer the materials from the quiz into real-world examples (details provided in class).

All quizzes are independent. You will find it useful to bring a calculator to the exams. I do not return exams, although students can arrange a time to meet with the TA to go over the exam.

GRADING

Exams and Deliverables	Points [or percentage]
Graded Online Homework	15
Class Participation	15
Mid-quarter Exams	45
Final Project	25
Total	100

COURSE POLICIES

Students are expected to be in their seats with their cell phones turned off prior to the start of class. Browsing the internet and other non-class related activities is strongly discouraged. Such activities make it difficult to pay attention during an online class.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of university intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind.

How the Honor Code applies to this course:

The honor code applies to everything you submit for this class including weekly online homework, case studies, and the midterm and final exams.

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**